

riorate the aesthetic of your Instagram story. You wouldn't want to see a scenic landscape with a bunch of words scrambled across it, now, would you? There are a couple of neat ways you can hide unsightly hashtags in your Insta stories. Firstly, if you are going to use a GIF in your story, you can simply type out all your hashtags (Insta allows a maximum of 10) and then resize them to be smaller. Note that Instagram won't register hashtags if you make them too small. Next, simply choose your GIF and place it strategically over your hashtags.



Hide those unsightly hashtags

If you're going the no-GIF, clean image route, you can type out your hashtags and make them relatively small yet again. However, this time around, tap on the hashtags and change the colour to best match your background. If you have blue skies, simply select blue and hide it in plain sight in the sky backdrop. Additionally, if you wish to pick the shade of blue closest to the shade of the sky and mask the hashtags more efficiently, just tap and hold the colour blue until you're greeted by a colour spectrum panel. Select the closest shade and mask your hashtags.



CREATE A COLOUR GRADIENT TEXT OR SHADOW TEXT

Text can be pretty boring on Instagram even though it gives you a decent array of

font options. If you want to add a bit of flair to your text, you can try these nifty tricks. Firstly, you can create a gradient or rainbow text effect. This is not a predefined effect but it is something you come across when you play around with Instagram stories a fair bit. Firstly, type any text into your story, which could be a plain text story or one with an image. Next, highlight that text by tapping and holding. Now, you will see the colour options below. Tap and hold the colour you want your gradient or rainbow to start at. You'll now see the colour spectrum (as mentioned in the previous trick). Now, the next part is tricky. With one finger, slide across the colour spectrum and with the other slide across the highlighted text. With some practice, you will have transformed your dreary, monotone text into a vibrant colour gradient text.

Similarly, if you want to spruce up your text, you can also create a drop shadow effect on your text. Firstly, type your text in the story, choose your font and resize as you see fit. Next, repeat these exact same steps with the same font and size, but a different colour. All you need to do now is layer the top layer of text slightly off-centre from the bottom layer. You will have successfully created a pretty neat-looking drop shadow text effect.



Create rainbow text for a splash of colour

APPS TO UP YOUR INSTA STORY GAME

Here are a couple of nifty apps that can elevate the quality and aesthetic of your stories on Instagram.



Word Swag

Word Swag can automatically

transform your text into gorgeous photo text designs for your story with their powerful Typomatic type engine.



Unfold

Unfold allows users to use

and even create beautiful, minimalist templates for their Instagram stories. They host an array of themes such as Film Frames, Ripped paper, Classico and more.



Kirakira+

Kirakira+ is an odd but useful app

that lets you add an animated shimmer to any real-life that lets you add an animated shimmer to any real-life. It can be applied to both photos and videos.



Microsoft Hyperlapse

Microsoft

Hyperlapse is incredibly useful since it not only lets you easily shoot hyperlapse videos but it also converts existing videos on your phone to hyperlapse ones.



8mm Vintage Camera

8mm Vintage

Camera is an exquisite paid app on iOS that lets you shoot videos in retro formats such as 8mm, 16mm and more. It even lets you apply retro effects to existing videos.



Later

Later, formerly known as Latergramme, is a simple app that lets users plan and schedule Instagram posts and stories.



CREATE A PHOTO COLLAGE STORY

You can create a quick, little collage right within Instagram without the help of other collage-making apps. It's quite simple on iOS and a bit more complicated (not by much) on Android. On iOS, simply go to your gallery and tap on 'Export' on an image on the bottom left on the screen. Click 'Copy' and then toggle to your Instagram story. Tap the screen to get the text cursor and then, simply paste it on a solid colour background. You can do this with as many pictures as you like, creating an aesthetic, freestyle collage by placing images in the space, with some slightly overlapping one another.

To do the same on Android, you will need to open your gallery and screenshot the images you want in your Instagram story. Crop these images to edit out the navigation buttons and status bar. After you have individually screenshotted and cropped each picture, go to Instagram and add a story. Then, simply apply a solid colour background. Now, tap the screen once so that the cursor arrives. Tap and hold the cursor and then the Clipboard option should be seen. Click on this and select the image you want and keep repeating the same process until you have taken all the relevant images from Clipboard. That's it, you have created a makeshift photo collage directly on your Insta story. 